Patient Guide: Essential Hypertension and Blood Pressure Care

PulseAI Clinical Reference Library — Evidence-Based Patient Information

1. UNDERSTANDING BLOOD PRESSURE READINGS

Blood pressure is recorded as systolic (pressure when heart beats) over diastolic (pressure when heart rests). Optimal blood pressure is below 120/80 mmHg. Hypertension is defined as persistent readings of 140/90 mmHg or higher across repeat clinical visits.

2. DAILY MEDICATION ADHERENCE

Antihypertensive medications (ACE inhibitors, ARBs, or Amlodipine) must be taken every day around the same time. Never abruptly discontinue blood pressure medication without clinical advice, as dangerous rebound hypertension can occur.

3. DIETARY & LIFESTYLE TARGETS (DASH DIET)

Reduce dietary sodium to under 2,000mg daily (under 1 teaspoon of table salt). Increase potassium-rich foods (bananas, spinach, legumes). Engage in at least 150 minutes of moderate aerobic exercise weekly and minimize alcohol consumption.

4. HYPERTENSIVE CRISIS — EMERGENCY ROOM CRITERIA

Seek emergency room care immediately if blood pressure exceeds 180/120 mmHg accompanied by severe thunderclap headache, sudden blurred vision, chest tightness, or facial numbness.

Document issued for clinical guidance and patient education. Consult your attending physician for personalized care.